

Vocabulary 04: Spaces We Live In

Unit 4, Environmental Design and Management. The unit's 61 Tier 3 words across the four topics, with a one-line definition written for a grade 6 to 7 reader and a Spanish column.

Translation status. The Spanish column is my best working translation and has not been verified by a native speaker. Use it for word banks and picture cards; have a native speaker, a bilingual colleague, or the ENL teacher check the whole table once before it is printed for students. The Topic 4.2 terms come from my own Color in the Home vocabulary cards from my certification coursework. Home repair and housing words are the ones most likely to differ by country (a breaker, an outlet, a plunger, and a condo have different everyday names across the Spanish-speaking countries), so the English term stays on every card, because students will see the English word on a real breaker panel, a real lease, and a real listing.

Two words carry a design meaning that is different from their everyday meaning. "Scale" here means the ratio on a floor plan (a quarter inch is one foot) and the size of a thing next to other things, not a kitchen scale. "Shade" here is a color mixed with black, not shade from the sun. "Level" is the tool.

How lessons use this file: each lesson names its own Tier 3 words; the handout for that lesson carries a word bank pulled from this table in both languages. The site's Materials page prints this table as picture-ready cards.

The table

#	Topic	English term	Student definition	Spanish
1	4.1	housing	Any place people live: a house, an apartment, a room, a tiny house.	vivienda
2	4.1	apartment	A home that is one unit inside a bigger building, usually rented.	apartamento (departamento)
3	4.1	condo	An apartment you own instead of rent. You share the building with other owners.	condominio

4	4.1	lease	The written agreement between a renter and a landlord. It says the rent, the dates, and the rules.	contrato de alquiler (arrendamiento)
5	4.1	rent	Money paid every month to live in a place someone else owns.	alquiler (renta)
6	4.1	mortgage	A loan from a bank to buy a home, paid back every month for many years.	hipoteca
7	4.1	hazard	Anything in a space that could hurt someone: a loose cord, a wet floor, a blocked exit.	peligro
8	4.1	smoke detector	A device on the ceiling that sounds an alarm when it senses smoke. Test it every month.	detector de humo
9	4.1	carbon monoxide detector	A device that sounds an alarm when it senses a gas you cannot see or smell, made by burning fuel.	detector de monóxido de carbono
10	4.1	circuit breaker	A switch in the electrical panel that shuts off the power to	interruptor automático (breaker)

			part of the home when too much is plugged in. You reset it by flipping it off, then on.	
11	4.1	outlet	The place in the wall where you plug something in.	enchufe (tomacorriente)
12	4.1	plunger	A tool with a rubber cup on a stick. You push and pull it over a drain to clear a clog.	destapador (desatascador)
13	4.1	level	A tool with a bubble in a tube. When the bubble is in the middle, the thing you are hanging is straight.	nivel
14	4.1	tape measure	A metal ribbon marked in inches and feet that pulls out and snaps back. Used to measure a room or a piece of furniture.	cinta métrica
15	4.1	maintenance	The small, regular jobs that keep a home working: change a filter, test a detector, tighten a screw.	mantenimiento
16	4.1	conserve	To use less of something so it lasts, like water	conservar (ahorrar)

			or electricity.	
17	4.1	energy	What makes things run: electricity, gas, oil, or the sun. A home uses it for heat, light, and appliances, and pays for it.	energía
18	4.1	phantom load	The electricity a device uses while it is off or on standby but still plugged in, like a TV or a game console.	consumo fantasma (en espera)
19	4.1	LED	A kind of bulb that uses much less electricity than an old bulb and lasts for years.	bombilla LED (foco LED)
20	4.1	thermostat	The control that sets how warm or cool a home is. Every degree you change it changes the bill.	termostato
21	4.1	insulation	The material inside walls and attics that slows heat from leaving in winter and entering in summer.	aislamiento
22	4.1	audit	A careful check of everything, one item at a time. A home energy audit checks every bulb, plug, window, and	auditoría

			setting.	
23	4.1	compost	Food scraps and yard waste that break down into soil instead of going to a landfill.	compost (abono orgánico)
24	4.1	recycle	To send a used thing (paper, cans, bottles) to be made into something new.	reciclar
25	4.1	reuse	To use something again instead of throwing it out, like a jar or a secondhand desk.	reutilizar
26	4.2	element (of design)	One of the basic parts a designer works with: line, shape, form, space, texture, pattern, color, light.	elemento
27	4.2	line	The path your eye follows: straight, curved, up and down, side to side. Tall lines make a room feel taller.	línea
28	4.2	shape	A flat outline, like the square of a window or the circle of a rug.	figura (forma)
29	4.2	form	A shape with depth, like a couch or a	forma (volumen)

			lamp. Something you could walk around.	
30	4.2	space	The room itself, and the empty parts of it. Too much furniture leaves no space to move.	espacio
31	4.2	texture	How a surface feels or looks like it would feel: rough, smooth, soft, shiny.	textura
32	4.2	pattern	A design that repeats: stripes, dots, plaid, flowers.	patrón (estampado)
33	4.2	color wheel	A circle that shows the colors in order and which ones mix to make which.	círculo cromático (rueda de colores)
34	4.2	primary color	Red, yellow, or blue. You cannot mix them from other colors; every other color comes from them.	color primario
35	4.2	secondary color	Orange, green, or purple. Each one is two primary colors mixed.	color secundario
36	4.2	tertiary color	A color made by mixing a primary and the secondary	color terciario

			next to it, like red-orange or blue-green.	
37	4.2	tint	A color with white added. Lighter and softer, like pink from red.	tinte (tono claro)
38	4.2	shade	A color with black added. Darker and heavier, like navy from blue.	sombra (tono oscuro)
39	4.2	warm colors	Red, orange, yellow. They make a room feel cozy, close, and full of energy.	colores cálidos
40	4.2	cool colors	Blue, green, purple. They make a room feel calm, open, and quiet.	colores fríos
41	4.2	palette	The small set of colors chosen for one room, usually three to five.	paleta
42	4.2	color scheme	The rule for how a palette's colors go together: all one color (monochromatic), opposites on the wheel (complementary), or neighbors (analogous).	esquema de colores
43	4.2	mood	The feeling a room gives you when you walk	ambiente (estado de ánimo)

			in: calm, energetic, cozy, focused.	
44	4.2	balance	When the visual weight in a room feels even, so no side looks heavier than the other.	equilibrio
45	4.2	symmetry	Balance where one side mirrors the other, like two matching lamps on two matching nightstands.	simetría
46	4.2	focal point	The first thing your eye goes to in a room: a window, a bed, a big picture, a fireplace.	punto focal
47	4.2	rhythm	A repeat that moves your eye through a room, like the same color showing up in three places.	ritmo
48	4.2	proportion	How the size of one thing compares to another. A huge couch in a tiny room is out of proportion.	proporción
49	4.2	scale	On a floor plan, the rule that a small length on paper stands for a real length (a quarter inch is one foot). In a	escala

			room, how big a thing is next to the people and things around it.	
50	4.2	floor plan	A drawing of a room or a home from above, showing the walls, doors, windows, and furniture to scale.	plano de planta
51	4.2	traffic flow	The path people walk through a room. Furniture should never block it.	flujo de circulación
52	4.2	zone	A part of a room set aside for one job: a sleep zone, a work zone, a sit zone, a store zone.	zona
53	4.2	universal design	Design that works for everyone: a child, a grandparent, a person in a wheelchair, a parent carrying groceries. Lever handles, wide doors, no steps.	diseño universal
54	4.3	client	The person you are designing for. Their needs come first, not your taste.	cliente
55	4.3	budget	The most money you can spend, and the	presupuesto

			plan for spending it. Every item on the plan has a price.	
56	4.3	model	A small copy of a room or a building you can hold, built to show the plan.	maqueta
57	4.3	prototype	The first version of a design, built to test it and find what to fix.	prototipo
58	4.4	interior designer	A person who plans the inside of a space: the layout, colors, furniture, and lighting, for a client.	diseñador de interiores
59	4.4	architect	A person who designs buildings and draws the plans a builder follows. Licensed after college and an exam.	arquitecto
60	4.4	contractor	A person who runs the building or repair job, hires the workers, and makes sure it is done right and on time.	contratista
61	4.1	tiny house	A very small home, often under 400 square feet,	casa diminuta (mini casa)

			with every zone squeezed into one space.	
--	--	--	--	--

Sentence starters

Print these on the back of the project sheet, the peer review sheet, and the repair station cards.

For the pitch (Lesson 4.8, 30 seconds; Lesson 4.15, 60 seconds)

English	Spanish
My client is ___ and needs ___.	Mi cliente es ___ y necesita ___.
I chose ___ colors because the mood is ___.	Elegí los colores ___ porque el ambiente es ___.
The focal point of the room is ___.	El punto focal de la habitación es ___.
The traffic flow goes from ___ to ___ without anything in the way.	El flujo de circulación va de ___ a ___ sin nada en medio.
I spent \$___ of my \$___ budget. The biggest item was ___.	Gasté \$___ de mi presupuesto de \$. El artículo más caro fue .
One safe or green choice I made is ___.	Una elección segura o ecológica que hice fue ___.

For the peer review (the gallery walk, Lesson 4.15; the thumbs vote, Lesson 4.8)

English	Spanish
One thing that works in this room is ___.	Algo que funciona en esta habitación es ___.
I can see the principle of ___ in ___.	Veó el principio de ___ en ___.
The client needed , and I see it in .	El cliente necesitaba , y lo veo en .
One question I have about the plan is ___.	Una pregunta que tengo sobre el plano es ___.
Next time, try ___.	La próxima vez, prueba ___.

For the repair stations (Lesson 4.3; the six-step troubleshooting frame)

English	Spanish
The problem is ___.	El problema es ___.
First I turn off ___ and check ___.	Primero apago ___ y reviso ___.
The tool I need is ___.	La herramienta que necesito es ___.
I fixed it by . It worked because .	Lo arreglé . Funcionó porque .
I would call an adult or a professional if ___.	Llamaría a un adulto o a un profesional si ___.
To keep it from happening again, ___.	Para que no vuelva a pasar, ___.